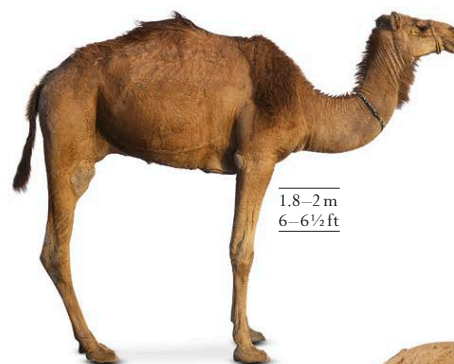


CAMELS AND RELATIVES

Unique within their order, members of the family Camelidae have just two toes, but no hoofs. Each toe has a small nail at its tip and a soft footpad, which can shift slightly to help maintain grip in mountainous terrain and prevent sinking in soft sand. They also have distinctive teeth, oval red blood cells, a three-chambered stomach, and a leg musculature that means they lie down resting on their knees.

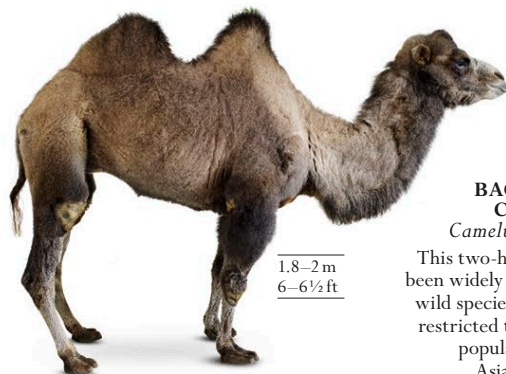
DROMEDARY *Camelus dromedarius*

Used for transport in arid regions, this Arabian species is supremely adapted to desert life. Only the feral Australian populations show wild characteristics.



1.8–2 m
6–6½ ft

85–90 cm
34–35 in



1.8–2 m
6–6½ ft

BACTRIAN CAMEL *Camelus bactrianus*

This two-humped camel has been widely domesticated. The wild species, *Camelus ferus*, is restricted to critically small populations in the Asian deserts.

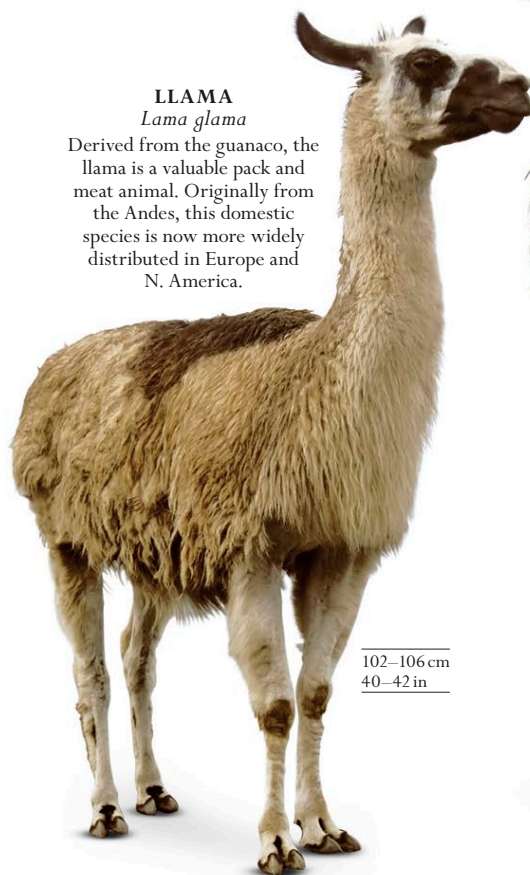


VICUÑA *Vicugna vicugna*

The smaller of the two wild Andean camelids, the vicuña produces a fine wool, which led to its domestication and development of the alpaca.

LLAMA *Lama glama*

Derived from the guanaco, the llama is a valuable pack and meat animal. Originally from the Andes, this domestic species is now more widely distributed in Europe and N. America.



102–106 cm
40–42 in



long, woolly coat

GUANACO *Lama guanicoe*

Native to the arid mountains of S. America, the guanaco has high levels of oxygen-carrying haemoglobin in the blood, enabling it to thrive at extreme altitudes.

nail on tip of toe

90–130 cm
35–51 in



85–90 cm
34–35 in

ALPACA *Vicugna pacos*

Kept in herds that graze high in the Andes, and now elsewhere in the world, this domestic species is an important source of wool.

HIPPOPOTAMUSES

Among the Artiodactyla, the family Hippopotamidae is unique in that its members walk on four toes on each foot. They also have a huge, barrel-shaped body, short but stout legs, and a large head. Their wide mouth, with tusk-like canine teeth, is used in feeding, fighting, and defence. Reflecting an amphibious lifestyle, the nostrils and eyes are on the top of the snout and the skin is smooth, lacking sweat glands.



75–100 cm
30–39 in

PYGMY HIPPOPOTAMUS *Choeropsis liberiensis*

An inhabitant of the forested swamps of W. Africa, this species is similar in shape to its larger relative, but its muzzle is proportionally smaller.



1.5–1.65 m
5–5½ ft

COMMON HIPPOPOTAMUS *Hippopotamus amphibius*

A solitary nocturnal grazer and sociable daytime wallower, this species is now found mainly in eastern and southern Africa.